common political organization were obliged hopelessly to protect their lives, farms, tribal independence, and religion against the superior might of the west." Before long, the fighting forked into a double war, one against the pagan Lithuanians, the other against nearby Christians who hoped to seize some of the land east of the Baltic for themselves.[10]

"It was completely joyless and full of hard fighting," writes Nicolaus von Jeroschin of the new Crusade, ". . . a land of horrors and wilderness . . . [where] the knightly sword of Christianity greedily devoured the sinners' flesh." For the next fifty years, the Teutonic Knights would lay waste to the lands of the Lithuanians—fighting, perhaps, for Christ, but hoping to gain themselves a kingdom.[11]

